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Report: 'State of Black America' grim

Trump policies dim
chances at American
dream, authors write

By Matt Brown
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The American dream may not be dead for many Black Americans, but it is further away than at any point since the Civil Rights Movement, warns a report by the National Urban League.

Released Thursday, the 50th annual "State of Black America" report grimly describes Black Americans' economic and political prospects as having worsened due to policy changes from President Donald Trump's administration, according to a copy obtained by The Associated Press.

The report contends that the challenges it highlights for Black communities are warning signs for the prosperity of all Americans.

"It may be the focus is us, but the impact is not just us," said Marc Morial, president and CEO of the National Urban League. "While they have targeted and focused on Black Americans, these attacks are going to impact broadly working Americans, poor Americans, aspirational middle-class Americans, and this is what this report points to."

Tracing the arc of American history, the Urban League describes Black Americans' struggle for emancipation from slavery and equal economic and political rights as a gruesome but optimistic part of the American story.

Now, the report says, the Trump administration is at odds with the goals and achievements of the Civil Rights Movement in the 1960s, citing the overhaul of the Justice Department's Civil Rights Division and the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission, as well

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Fans react as 5 Seconds of Summer takes the stage in Grant Park on Thursday, the first day of Lollapalooza.
ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

'GO BIG OR GO HOME'

LOLLAPALOOZA OPENS FOR 2026

By Finnegan Belleau, Kate Perez, Evgenia Anastasakos,
Doug George and Kayla Samoy | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

This year's Lollapalooza music festival opened Thursday in a sunny, sold-out Grant Park with Lorde and hometown artist John Summit as the day-capping headliners and a capacity crowd of a reported 115,000 inside the fences — with everyone seeming to have a different favorite they were there to see.

South Loop residents Ashley Lahay and Max Wertz, both 21, arrived at the main entrance on Ida B. Wells Drive early, decked out in rhinestone stickers and glitter. It was their first time at Lollapalooza and they were attending all four days.

"We decided to go all out," Lahay said.
"Go big or go home," Wertz added.

Lahay and Wertz said they're excited to see indie-pop singer-songwriter Audrey Hobert, Lorde and Finnish indie-pop duo Pearly Drops, who they had discovered just hours before the festival.

Lorde last headlined in 2017 in a performance cut short by a thunderstorm.

Siblings Makenzie and Brayden Sumner said they traveled from Kentucky to celebrate Makenzie Sumner's birthday and graduation at the festival. The six-hour drive was "worth it," she said.

Makenzie Sumner, 18, said she was looking forward to Asha Banks' set on the T-Mobile stage, the English pop singer's first music festival appearance in the United States. Brayden Sumner, 19, said he was planning to catch English heavy metal

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Thornton Fractional North head basketball coach Tim Bankston cheers on his team during a home game against Shepard High School on Jan. 10, 2023. MICHAEL GARD/FOR THE DAILY SOUTHTOWN

'Inspired hundreds'

Tim Bankston, a former Simeon star and beloved basketball coach, fatally shot

By Tess Kenny, Rebecca Johnson and Steve Millar
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Wayne Montgomery found something of a surrogate father in his basketball coach at Thornton Fractional North High School in Calumet City. He lost his father at a young age, so it was Tim Bankston who taught him how to be a man.

He demonstrated a firm handshake. He preached honesty and discipline. He also was a stickler for academic success, consistently asking whether Montgomery studied for exams and finished homework.

"He gave me those things that maybe my mother couldn't," Montgomery, now 35, said.

It's why Montgomery was so

devastated when he learned Bankston, 60, had been fatally shot on the city's South Side Wednesday morning.

A local basketball star who led Chicago's Simeon Career Academy to a state title in the '80s and went on to coach at south suburban T.F. North, Bankston was found with a gunshot wound to his abdomen inside an Auburn Gresham residence just before 10 a.m., per Chicago police and the

See **BANKSTON** on Page A5

Medinah Temple owner ready to roll dice again on a post-Bally's future

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For more than a century, historic Medinah Temple has stood as Chicago's exotic monument to adaptive reuse.

The Moorish-style amphitheater topped by two massive copper onion domes has hosted the annual Shrine Circus, recording sessions for the Chicago Symphony Orchestra and, after flirting with demolition at the dawn of the new millennium, a furniture store.

Operating as a temporary casino since September 2023, the ornate 132,600-square-foot building on Wabash Avenue will soon need to reinvent itself again after Bally's moves into its permanent facility next year.

"I'm completely open-minded," said Albert Friedman, 77, who is on his second run as owner of the landmarked Medinah Temple. "I want to come up with the highest and best use for the future of the

property."

A prolific real estate developer dubbed the "Mayor of River North" for his extensive renovation and repurposing of historic buildings lining the once-dilapidated Near North Side neighborhood, Friedman is already reimagining Medinah Temple as an experiential palace, with everything from a boutique hotel to a brick-and-mortar mall for online retailers on the table.

For a man who turned a hot dog stand into a real estate empire, anything is possible.

Founded in 1970, Friedman Properties began with a portfolio of two inherited buildings, including the family's hot dog stand at 500 N. Clark St. It now encompasses more than 50 buildings and 5 million square feet, accumulated and renovated across five decades.

Decked out in a suit, the spry Friedman recently led a

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CHICAGOLAND

City will seek to dismiss federal complaint in Adam Toledo case

The city of Chicago plans to seek dismissal of a new federal complaint filed by the family of Adam Toledo, the 13-year-old boy who was shot and killed by a Chicago police officer in 2021. **A3**

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